



Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **USAASA to implement approved USAF manual** — ITWeb South Africa, 5 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's universal service agency says the communications minister has approved the manual for the Universal Service and Access Fund, setting its objectives, governance, funding instruments and accountability. An earlier draft was withdrawn in November 2025 and a revised one went out for comment in February 2026. Also under [Access to services](#) and [Connectivity](#).
- **Sierra Leone to develop national AI roadmap for justice sector with UNESCO support** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

Sierra Leone's judiciary and the attorney-general's office are to draft a national artificial-intelligence roadmap for the justice sector with UNESCO, beginning with the security sector. Participants at the convening pointed to electronic filing and digital case management; no timetable is given. Also under [AI](#).
- **Namibia reviews digital trade framework for AfCFTA protocol implementation** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026 NAMIBIA

Namibia's assessment of its laws and institutions against the African free-trade area's Protocol on Digital Trade went to a validation workshop in Windhoek. It will feed a National Digital Trade Action Plan; no findings are published. Also under [Regional collaboration](#).
- **African Union, EU review infrastructure cooperation following 7th AU-EU Summit** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026 AFRICA

The African Union's infrastructure and energy commissioner and the European Union's ambassador to the AU reviewed cooperation after their seventh summit. On digital infrastructure they covered the continental digital transformation and artificial-intelligence strategies and European support for regulation and data governance. Also under [EU activities](#), [Regional collaboration](#) and [Connectivity](#).

Legislation and regulation

- **وزارة تكنولوجيا الاتصال: إجراءات جديدة لتوفير حماية أكبر للأطفال على شبكة الإنترنت** — Al Chourouk, 5 October 2026 TUNISIA

Tunisia's communications ministry announced child-protection measures resting on a telecommunications regulator's decision of 10 June 2026. Internet providers must offer parental controls covering site blacklists, device management and access-time limits, tell subscribers about them and write a child-protection clause into contracts. Also under [Access to services](#).

- **African ICT regulators told to unite against cross-border digital threats** — Capital FM Kenya, 5 October 2026

KENYA

SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

Opening the same Nairobi session, the head of Kenya's communications regulator urged African regulators to pool their efforts against fraud, cyber threats and cable disruptions that cross borders. He said Kenya has promulgated a new market structure for telecommunications and postal services and is reviewing its sector laws. Also under [Regional collaboration](#).

Regional collaboration

- **ECOWAS pushes biometric ID toward region-wide border acceptance by December** — Biometric Update, 5 October 2026

GHANA

WEST AFRICA

ECOWAS is running public campaigns in Ghana and Nigeria ahead of its December 2026 target for all member states to accept its biometric identity card at air, land and sea borders. Seven member states have issued the card so far. Also under [Digital Identity and CRVS](#).

- **African telecom regulators convene in Nairobi to strengthen cooperation on emerging digital challenges** — iPRIS, 5 October 2026

SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

A European-funded regulatory capacity programme is holding its eighth cohort in Nairobi from 5 to 9 October. Regulators from Liberia, Mauritius, Namibia, Sierra Leone, Tanzania and Zimbabwe are taking part with three regional regulators' associations. Also under [Training and skills](#).

- **Afreximbank and EABC Expand Digital Trade Access for East African Businesses through Africa Trade Gateway** — Afreximbank, 5 October 2026

EAST AFRICA

Afreximbank made the East African Business Council a trade corridor partner of its Africa Trade Gateway, to bring the region's firms onto its matchmaking, trade finance and payment services. The bank puts the gateway in more than 45 countries with 110 banks and 25,000 verified companies. Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).

- **Namibia reviews digital trade framework for AfCFTA protocol implementation** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

NAMIBIA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

- **African Union, EU review infrastructure cooperation following 7th AU-EU Summit** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

AFRICA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

- **African ICT regulators told to unite against cross-border digital threats** — Capital FM Kenya, 5 October 2026

KENYA

SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

Standards

- **Somalia's mobile money remains locked in silos** — ITWeb Africa, 5 October 2026

SOMALIA

The chief executive of Somalia's SomLink Telecom says voice calls now interconnect across six operators while mobile-money wallets remain closed to one another. He calls for cost-based pricing and shared rails, and says the largest operators have little commercial reason to open up. Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech and Connectivity](#).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Tariq Malik says countries should export DPI mistakes, not just expertise** — Biometric Update, 5 October 2026

MALAWI

GLOBAL

Tariq Malik, a World Bank identity adviser, argues that countries sharing digital public infrastructure should export their mistakes as well as their expertise. He proposes an exit test for partnerships and a published time-to-redress, and cites Malawi's enrolment of about nine million adults in roughly 180 days. Also under [Digital Identity and CRVS](#) and [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).

- **Kenya's health system has a ghost** — Daily Nation, 5 October 2026

KENYA

A newspaper column asks what Kenya's Sh104.8 billion health digitisation contract of 2024 paid for, now that hospitals are being moved from one Social Health Authority system to another. It cites a 2025 patient-group survey in which six in ten respondents said they had been denied care at least once over system failures. Also under [Sectoral management information systems](#).

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

- **Here's how much government collected towards digital migration in the last five years** — The Citizen, 5 October 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's communications minister told Parliament that about R1.29 billion was collected for the Universal Service and Access Fund over five years and about R652 million was unspent at the end of 2025/26. Spending that year included a R567 million write-off of set-top-box inventory, and there is still no analogue switch-off date. Also under [Connectivity](#).

New investments

- **E182m data centre loan not cancelled - Neal** — Times of Eswatini, 5 October 2026

ESWATINI

Eswatini's finance ministry says the E182 million India Exim Bank loan for a disaster recovery site at Siteki has not been cancelled. What the minister meant in Parliament was the commitment fee on the undrawn balance, which the lender has agreed to stop; 1% of the loan has been drawn. Also under [Data Storage](#).

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Éducation : la Fondation Orange Guinée et l'UNICEF signent un partenariat pour numériser 50 écoles** — Mediaguinee, 5 October 2026

GUINEA

Fondation Orange Guinée and UNICEF signed a protocol at Conakry on 5 October to equip 50 schools across six regions with digital learning hubs. It also provides for training 500 adolescents in science and digital skills and for 100 scholarships and prizes; no budget is stated. Also under [Access to services](#) and [Training and skills](#).

- **The Emerging Digital Battleground: The Critical Factors That Produce Advantage in the U.S.-China Competition for Digital Networks** — RAND Corporation, 5 October 2026

GLOBAL

A RAND study of the contest between the United States and China over third countries' digital networks finds that cost, bundled offers and presence on the ground give China structural advantages. The authors set out five priorities for the United States to close the gap. Also under [US / hyperscaler activities](#) and [China activities](#).

- **CAMTEL to Sign Connectivity Agreements with MINESEC and SIC on Wednesday** — Tech Africa News, 5 October 2026 CAMEROON

Cameroon's state operator CAMTEL says it will sign two framework agreements on 7 October: one with the secondary education ministry on connectivity for schools, the other with the state housing company on connectivity in housing estates. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

- **USAASA to implement approved USAF manual** — ITWeb South Africa, 5 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

- **Somalia's mobile money remains locked in silos** — ITWeb Africa, 5 October 2026 SOMALIA
Summarised under [Standards](#).

- **Here's how much government collected towards digital migration in the last five years** — The Citizen, 5 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure](#).

- **African Union, EU review infrastructure cooperation following 7th AU-EU Summit** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026 AFRICA
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

Data Storage

- **Tlou weighs Kala data centre expansion** — ITWeb Africa, 5 October 2026 BOTSWANA

Tlou Energy's annual report says Botswana's gas-powered Kala Data Centre ran well below its design of about 1MW in the year to June 2026, for lack of gas from the one connected well. The company has begun planning a pipeline from a second well, and any expansion depends on gas supply and funding. *Also under [Energy](#).*

- **Land availability gives SA edge in data centre race** — ITWeb South Africa, 5 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
A market study by DC Byte puts Africa at 3% of the 93GW of data-centre capacity built or planned across Europe, the Middle East and Africa. It names available land as South Africa's advantage and the time taken to deliver power as its constraint. *Also under [Energy](#).*

- **Continent 8 Technologies launches data center in Johannesburg, South Africa** — Data Center Dynamics, 5 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Continent 8 Technologies, which hosts online gaming and betting operators, announced its first African data centre, in Johannesburg. It did not disclose the site or any colocation partner. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

- **E182m data centre loan not cancelled - Neal** — Times of Eswatini, 5 October 2026 ESWATINI
Summarised under [New investments](#).

Energy

- **Tlou weighs Kala data centre expansion** — ITWeb Africa, 5 October 2026 BOTSWANA

Summarised under [Data Storage](#).

- **Land availability gives SA edge in data centre race** — ITWeb South Africa, 5 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [Data Storage](#).

Technical Capacity

- **ZARC reaches 1.5m active .ZA domains** — ITWeb South Africa, 5 October 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's domain registry reports 1.5 million active registrations across its four commercial second-level namespaces. It says that makes .ZA the first African country-code domain to reach the mark. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

Cybersecurity

- **Electronic transactions reached 865 billion Libyan dinars by end of September 2026: CBL** — Libya Herald, 5 October 2026

LIBYA

Libya's central bank said electronic transactions reached about 865 billion dinars by the end of September 2026. The figure came from a meeting between the governor, commercial bank heads and the state payments company on cash liquidity, wider electronic payment and cyber-risk readiness. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

- **Cyber Security Authority (CSA) Ghana opens NCSAM 2026 with call for stronger cybersecurity collaboration** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

GHANA

Ghana's Cyber Security Authority opened its 2026 awareness month with a call for banks, fintechs and telecoms operators to share threat information as routine. The national response team recorded 3,876 incidents between January and July 2026, about 47% of them online fraud. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Nigeria voters' register now stands at 103 million – INEC** — Vanguard, 5 October 2026

NIGERIA

Nigeria's electoral commission chairman said the national register of voters stands at more than 103 million after the final biometric clean-up. Three phases of continuous registration added 10,772,421 voters, and card collection begins nationwide on 9 October. *Also under [Registries and National statistics](#).*

- **Tariq Malik says countries should export DPI mistakes, not just expertise** — Biometric Update, 5 October 2026

MALAWI

GLOBAL

Summarised under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).

- **ECOWAS pushes biometric ID toward region-wide border acceptance by December** — Biometric Update, 5 October 2026

GHANA

WEST AFRICA

Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Five numbers showing how GTCO's payments strategy is taking shape** — TechCabal, 5 October 2026

NIGERIA

An analysis of Guaranty Trust Holding Company's half-year results shows its payments subsidiary HabariPay earning ₦7.81 billion in profit, close to double a year earlier, on ₦74.72 trillion switched. Transfers through its Pay-with-Transfer service reached ₦1.11 trillion while USSD use fell. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

- **Somalia's mobile money remains locked in silos** — ITWeb Africa, 5 October 2026

SOMALIA

Summarised under [Standards](#).

- **Electronic transactions reached 865 billion Libyan dinars by end of September 2026: CBL** — Libya Herald, 5 October 2026 LIBYA
Summarised under [Cybersecurity](#).
- **Cyber Security Authority (CSA) Ghana opens NCSAM 2026 with call for stronger cybersecurity collaboration** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026 GHANA
Summarised under [Cybersecurity](#).
- **Afreximbank and EABC Expand Digital Trade Access for East African Businesses through Africa Trade Gateway** — Afreximbank, 5 October 2026 EAST AFRICA
Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).

Registries

- **UDP demands full disclosure of supplementary voter data** — The Standard, 5 October 2026 GAMBIA
The Gambia's United Democratic Party asked the electoral commission to explain a gap of 28,932 between the 212,095 supplementary registrations it announced and the 183,163 in the dataset given to the party. It wants the figures before and after de-duplication, the records deleted and the method used, and says it is not alleging malpractice. *Also under [Open data](#).*
- **Nigeria voters' register now stands at 103 million – INEC** — Vanguard, 5 October 2026 NIGERIA
Summarised under [Digital Identity and CRVS](#).

Sectoral management information systems

- **Minette Libom Li Likeng : « La transformation numérique s'impose aujourd'hui comme un levier de modernisation de l'action publique »** — Le quotidien L'Economie, 5 October 2026 CAMEROON
Cameroon's posts and telecommunications minister handed four platforms built under the World Bank-financed digital transformation project to the agriculture ministry on 1 October. They cover e-learning for training schools, a soil-fertility map and agro-pastoral statistics, and soil sampling was launched the same day. *Also under [Rural digital data capture](#) and [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).*
- **Kenya's health system has a ghost** — Daily Nation, 5 October 2026 KENYA
Summarised under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **Burundi : la numérisation de la justice face au défi de la connectivité** — wearetech.africa, 5 October 2026 BURUNDI
Burundi is preparing an E-Justice platform to link the penal chain from the judicial police to the prisons, with online complaints and case tracking for citizens. An earlier programme digitised more than 15,000 case files, and the article sets the plan against an internet use rate of about 11%. *Also under [Digital divides](#).*
- **Tariq Malik says countries should export DPI mistakes, not just expertise** — Biometric Update, 5 October 2026 MALAWI GLOBAL
Summarised under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).
- **Minette Libom Li Likeng : « La transformation numérique s'impose aujourd'hui comme un levier de modernisation de l'action publique »** — Le quotidien L'Economie, 5 October 2026 CAMEROON

Summarised under [Sectoral management information systems](#).

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

- [Minette Libom Li Likeng : « La transformation numérique s'impose aujourd'hui comme un levier de modernisation de l'action publique »](#) — Le quotidien L'Economie, 5 October 2026 CAMEROON

Summarised under [Sectoral management information systems](#).

Technology

AI

- [Sierra Leone to develop national AI roadmap for justice sector with UNESCO support](#) — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

ICT Industry

- [Zamtel unveils MyZamtel Super App and two Zambia-first digital innovations](#) — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026 ZAMBIA

Zambia's Zamtel launched a self-care application with a build-your-own-bundle option, and Kongola Malaiti, a digital financial service reached by short code. No user figures are given. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

- [ZARC reaches 1.5m active .ZA domains](#) — ITWeb South Africa, 5 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [Technical Capacity](#).

- [Five numbers showing how GTCO's payments strategy is taking shape](#) — TechCabal, 5 October 2026 NIGERIA

Summarised under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).

- [Continent 8 Technologies launches data center in Johannesburg, South Africa](#) — Data Center Dynamics, 5 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [Data Storage](#).

Capacity

Training and skills

- [Éducation : la Fondation Orange Guinée et l'UNICEF signent un partenariat pour numériser 50 écoles](#) — Mediaguinee, 5 October 2026 GUINEA

Summarised under [Connectivity](#).

- [African telecom regulators convene in Nairobi to strengthen cooperation on emerging digital challenges](#) — iPRIS, 5 October 2026 SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).

Inclusion

Access to services

- [وزارة تكنولوجيايات الاتصال: إجراءات جديدة لتوفير حماية أكبر للأطفال على شبكة الإنترنت](#) – Al Chourouk, 5 October 2026

TUNISIA

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

- [Éducation : la Fondation Orange Guinée et l'UNICEF signent un partenariat pour numériser 50 écoles](#) – Mediaguinee, 5 October 2026

GUINEA

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- [Zamtel unveils MyZamtel Super App and two Zambia-first digital innovations](#) – Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

ZAMBIA

Summarised under [ICT Industry](#).

- [USAASA to implement approved USAF manual](#) – ITWeb South Africa, 5 October 2026

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Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

- [CAMTEL to Sign Connectivity Agreements with MINESEC and SIC on Wednesday](#) – Tech Africa News, 5 October 2026

CAMEROON

Summarised under [Connectivity](#).

Digital divides

- [Burundi : la numérisation de la justice face au défi de la connectivité](#) – wearetech.africa, 5 October 2026

BURUNDI

Summarised under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).

Data

National statistics

- [Nigeria voters' register now stands at 103 million – INEC](#) – Vanguard, 5 October 2026

NIGERIA

Summarised under [Digital Identity and CRVS](#).

Open data

- [UDP demands full disclosure of supplementary voter data](#) – The Standard, 5 October 2026

GAMBIA

Summarised under [Registries](#).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

- [The Emerging Digital Battleground: The Critical Factors That Produce Advantage in the U.S.-China Competition for Digital Networks](#) – RAND Corporation, 5 October 2026

GLOBAL

Summarised under [Connectivity](#).

China activities

- [The Emerging Digital Battleground: The Critical Factors That Produce Advantage in the U.S.-China Competition for Digital Networks](#) — RAND Corporation, 5 October 2026 GLOBAL

Summarised under [Connectivity](#).

EU activities

- [African Union, EU review infrastructure cooperation following 7th AU-EU Summit](#) — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026 AFRICA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-10-05-2
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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country pages and the monthly reports.